

About Northanger Abbey

Northanger Abbey is a romantic comedy visual novel. It is a queer, interactive adaption of the nineteenth century novel of the same name by Jane Austen. You play as Kit/Catherine/Christopher Morland, a seventeen year old from country England who is visiting the fashionable city of Bath for the first time. You meet other young people with whom you can dance, flirt, and discuss your favourite Gothic Romances.

You can play as male, female, or non-binary, and separately choose whether to present as masculine, feminine, or androgynous. You can also choose to be trans or cis, or leave it unspecified. These choices do not change the plot or romances in any significant way, but affect how scenes play out.

You can choose to follow the original plot of the book and befriend the Tilney siblings while being principled, but possibly naive. Or you can throw in your lot with the antagonists of the original novel, the Thorpe siblings, though in this case being principled or naive may not end so well. There is also the chance to uncover the secret route through scenes hidden in plain sight.

There is diverse representation of POC, disabled characters, and queerness, and accessibility features such as image descriptions and support for large text sizes.

[Trailer on youtube](#)

History and links

The original version of Northanger Abbey was released as free/pay-what-you-want on itch.io in 2019 as [Northanger Abbey: The Game](#). It was well received, especially amongst fans of the original novel, and was positively discussed in the Polygon article [Indie game designers were refashioning the Regency long before Bridgerton](#).

A revamped, paid version was released in 2025 on itch.io as [Northanger Abbey: Rewritten](#), and then on Steam in 2026 as [Northanger Abbey](#). This new version has entirely new sprites and backgrounds, includes various fixes, and adds multiple short side routes. Besides from the slight difference in name, the new itch.io and Steam versions are identical.

Features

- All the key scenes from the original novel, along with new scenes and interactive choices, adding up to over 60 thousand words
- A light-hearted coming of age romance which affectionately satirises the tropes of its own genre, while exploring themes of gender, relationships, and society
- Choose love or friendship: full routes with Henry or Eleanor Tilney, shorter routes with Isabella or John Thorpe, and a Secret Route
- Choose the main character's pronouns, presentation, and personality, and explore how this changes the story
- Orchestral soundtrack featuring classical composers, including Bach and Vivaldi
- Screenreader support, descriptions of music and images, and customisable font and text size

Love Interests

You have the chance to befriend or romance four love interests, who are all in their early 20s:



Henry Tilney: Under the jokes, he's earnest and kind, and charmed by your enthusiasm. For fans of green flag boys with a sense of humour.



Eleanor Tilney: A sad, sweet, bookish trans woman. For fans of soft romance.



Isabella Thorpe: Sugar-sweet on the surface, a two-faced schemer underneath. For fans of toxic romance.



John Tilney: You have met this guy at a party and he tried to sell you crypto while talking constantly about his car. For fans of oddly endearing train wrecks.

There is also a secret route, involving a non-binary character who has been secretly watching events from the sidelines.

The Henry and Eleanor routes are full length, while the Isabella, John, and secret routes are short.